Crew Resource Management Cheatsheet

Effective communication

- If you think comms are breaking down, stop and fix that first.
- Appoint a PM, leader, or communications officer if needed.
- Message → read-back → acknowledgement.

Shared mental model

- Do we have the same idea of the goal and how we get there?
- Fully understand situation before beginning.
- Common terminology for communication.
- Write stuff down (succinctly) for reference.

Short-term strategy

- Everyone should know what comes next and their roles.
- Updated as time goes on, as much as needed.
- Briefings: Stop → Assess → Plan → (Questions) → Go/no-go.

Situational awareness

- Ensure coordination; announce significant actions.
- Announce any significant observations to others.
- Have "lookouts" when the environment is too complex.

Challenge and response

- When you see something off, speak up and expect a response.
- Attention → Concern → Root-problem → Proposal → Buy-in.

Error management

- Prepare reactions and react sooner rather than later.
- Something goes wrong: analyze system, no human blame.
- Facts → Timeline → Analysis → Recommendations.

Richard Darst / CC-0 / 2026-05-26

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Crew Resource Management

A great team doesn't come from great people, it comes from great teamwork.

Crew Resource Management is practices to allow the fullest use of all resources available. It was created because things like "just do what the leader says" or not speaking up repeatedly led to disaster.

Teamwork is a skill that is learned. Practice when it's easy going and you can do it when it's hard. Think about it and take the time to improve.

The points on the back can guide your planning, meetings, and emergency responses.

Briefing:
- Stop
- Assess
- Plan
- (Questions)
- Go/no-go

Assertion:
- Attention
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